databases and infrastructures and those whose job it is to circumvent or break down the defenses of the enemy in order to expose, sabotage, destroy, and silence them. This duality exists not only at the political and military level but also in other sectors of society—the economy, banking, science, the high-tech sector, and so on.

At the end of the 1990s, cyber warfare in the United States was classified as an additional weapon in the nonconventional weapons arsenal. This meant that cyber warfare joined the club of chemical, biological, and nuclear weapons capabilities. Decision makers and shapers of public opinion around the world classify cyber warfare as a weapon that, while seemingly "clean" or "dry"—that is, it does not kill people directly—has the potential to cause no less damage to a particular country and to humankind in general than that caused by other nonconventional weapons.

The transformation that took place in the realm of information and communications between the mid-1970s and the twenty-first century propelled cyberspace, and its destructive potential, to a level that no one could have imagined. In the past, the most common wireless communication systems were HF and UHF, their transmission was usually via Morse code, and the encryption was manual or mechanical. The world of that era was bipolar and stable. Today's world is multipolar and much less stable. Back then, the world was large, scattered, and decentralized. Now it is a global village. Today's world is characterized by the following:

- Online communication from any point on earth to any other point on earth
- Complete transparency among all the inhabitants of the world
- Meaningless international borders
- The convergence of global terrorism and global criminal organizations
- The primacy of real time—information that is not used in real time is irrelevant
- Intelligence from open sources (OSINT) being top priority
- A reality in which, if you have identified a weak link in the global IT network, you can easily penetrate the sea of global data, extract and plant information, plant bugs, and cause disruption and destruction, either in real time or whenever you choose